

Maria Silva

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Organised, reliable and detail-focused professional with experience managing complex workloads under pressure, maintaining accurate records, communicating clearly with clients and colleagues, and taking responsibility for outcomes in high-stakes environments. Background spans legal advisory work, placement at an international law firm, and client-facing roles requiring sound judgement, consistent standards, and the ability to coordinate others effectively. Based in the Reading area and available for part-time hours.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme: Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize — top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a varied caseload simultaneously, meeting firm deadlines across welfare, housing, employment and debt matters
- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, identifies key issues and translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Drafts correspondence and prepares documents; maintains accurate, confidential case records
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria and researches complex points to ensure advice is reliable and up to date

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Became the sole junior coordinating document management and deadline tracking for the team ahead of a significant submission — kept operations running smoothly under pressure
- Reviewed and organised large volumes of documents; maintained structured electronic case files; monitored and met procedural deadlines
- Liaised with the client and an external translator to coordinate required materials; tracked outstanding actions to ensure on-time delivery
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

- Assisted with hearing preparation, electronic bundling, court filings and deadline tracking across multiple live matters
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with matter opening, closure and cost comparisons
- Prepared client notes and coordinated hearing arrangements, requiring reliable communication and attention to detail

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a client matter from instruction through to formal written advice, coordinating with a supervising solicitor and meeting a firm deadline
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, practical guidance; communicated directly with the client throughout

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve queries and reconcile competing priorities
- Reviewed and amended commercial contracts; flagged provisions needing further input and communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on contractual risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Document review and organisation, hearing bundles, procedural deadline tracking, case-file maintenance, coordinating multiple concurrent matters